

profitability continues to be a challenge. How will you address that?

A: When we think about building our business over the long term, we just see an enormous opportunity to continue growing our community and growing our revenue. So far, we've made the decision to run our business right about at break-even and continue to reinvest so that we can make great new products that our community loves. We want to continue to reach more people and invest in our app platform to drive more performance for advertisers. And so as long as we continue to see that really big long-term opportunity, we will want to carefully balance profitability, so that we don't optimise around short-term profits over the long-term growth in our business.

In terms of what lies ahead, we're bringing ML tools into Lens Studio, which is our developer environment that allows people to build AR lenses. A lot of these AI-assisted tools will help people build high-quality lenses faster and also help generate some of the 3D assets necessary to build an amazing AR experience. Historically, 3D assets have been really hard to build and AI can help build those faster.

"It's always been about friends and family connecting. We know that a picture's worth a thousand words. That means you can share what you're doing and who you're with visually, through Snapchat"

Q: What will India's place be in the overall Snap ecosystem over the next three to five years?

A: We've seen so much extraordinary growth here but it's also very early. Apart from building out our team, we're supporting content creators and developers and helping them embrace our tools. There is work being done with our own team and advertisers so that we can help folks continue to grow their businesses here in India by using our advertising tools. In many ways, I think we're just building the foundation in India over

the next couple of years, as we continue to grow our community and our engagement with advertisers and developers.

Q: If you look back in time, what was that moment you believed that Snapchat was set to take off?

A: There were a couple of big moments. The first one was probably when we had maybe 10 or 15 friends using Snapchat. When Bobby and I first started working together, we built a piece of software called Future Freshman that was designed to help people apply to college. And we were very excited... we worked 18 months on this, it was very complex. And nobody used it, not even our siblings.

With Snapchat, I would sit in the back of my college classes and every now and then check the counter and see the numbers increasing from 1,000 to 2,000 to 20,000 and that was really exciting. The second big moment was probably moving out of my dad's house, which was a very big, big step for me. He was very kind and let seven or eight of us all live in his house when we were working on the service in the early days.

Q: What are your thoughts on the metaverse? | 279

A: Our investment is focussed on AR and not virtual reality (VR) because our big bet is on the real world. We believe people like the real world or being with their real friends in the real world. They don't want to have to give up all the benefits of reality to access computing.

When I was growing up, I was really into computers, [and] I would have to go to the computer lab and couldn't play outside with my friends. Phones have helped us take a step towards integrating computing more into our lives. But even today, you walk down the street and there are people with heads buried in this little screen. With AR and glasses, we'll be able to share computing experiences in a way that hasn't been possible before, and stay in our environment or in the reality that we all share and enjoy.

We've been working on our glasses for almost 10 years. One of the things that I enjoy about [that] is that the technology is very difficult and it makes it much harder to copy. Historically, we've worked on products that are easier to copy and software is one such [product]. As we push harder with our AR glasses, we've worked to unlock some very complex technical challenges to be able to fit all of that computing and those displays into a lightweight and wearable pair of glasses. **BT**

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